

# project-atlas command cheatsheet

a derived, auditable knowledgebase over your repository's documentation.

Every command below is `atlas <name>` in a shell and `/atlas:<name>` in Claude Code. ■ shell only □ Claude Code only

## Starting out

|                              |                                                           |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>build</code>           | adopt this repository and generate the site               |
| <code>help</code>            | this map                                                  |
| <code>config [--json]</code> | tune the taxonomy, the blocking signals, the stale window |
| <code>version</code>         | which build is answering, and whether it is behind        |

## Seeing where things stand

|                                       |                                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <span>□</span> <code>status</code>    | the corpus, the rot and the one next action                                       |
| <code>health [--verbose]</code>       | the full rot report                                                               |
| <code>tasks [word]</code>             | the plan as progress bars                                                         |
| <code>design [--scaffold]</code>      | which design documents exist, and which are scaffolds still owing their substance |
| <span>□</span> <code>dashboard</code> | build, serve and hand back a URL                                                  |

## Working on a change

|                                    |                                                   |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <code>branch [type slug]</code>    | is it safe to commit here                         |
| <code>plan [slug]</code>           | propose the route and run none of it              |
| <code>changes [--json]</code>      | what is uncommitted and which documents cite it   |
| <code>diff &lt;file&gt;</code>     | one file, explained                               |
| <span>□</span> <code>review</code> | what this diff breaks or fixes, before the commit |

## Picking up cold

|                                               |                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>state [--json]</code>                   | what a resuming session reads first                                 |
| <code>handoff</code>                          | the derived half of a handoff, for the half only a person can write |
| <code>note &lt;kind&gt; "&lt;text&gt;"</code> | record one decision, trap or blocker                                |

## Digging into history

|                                  |                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>contrib [--json]</code>    | commits over time                                                                 |
| <code>ownership [--json]</code>  | authors per area, and where the bus factor is one                                 |
| <code>surviving [--json]</code>  | lines still in the tree                                                           |
| <code>worklog [--day D]</code>   | what landed today                                                                 |
| <code>sessions [--out F]</code>  | how sessions went — turns, interruptions, friction, rework                        |
| <code>tokens [--out FILE]</code> | token accounting from local session transcripts — opt-in, never published         |
| <code>--snapshot</code>          | append the counts-only day rollout to .atlas/tokens.jsonl (needs tokens.snapshot) |

## What git history says, and nothing else here reads

|                                                   |                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>git-insights [sect]</code>                  | all of it at once                                                |
| <span>□</span> <code>git-hotspots</code>          | the files change keeps returning to, what changes together       |
| <span>□</span> <code>git-history</code>           | cadence and commit hygiene                                       |
| <span>□</span> <code>git-branch</code>            | branch state and the branch inventory                            |
| <code>git-tree</code>                             | the branch topology — what was cut from what, drawn as a tree    |
| <span>□</span> <code>git-status</code>            | where you are, what is uncommitted, and what this change touches |
| <span>□</span> <code>git-diff &lt;path&gt;</code> | one file, with the history around it                             |

## Stopping and picking back up

|                                |                                                                               |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>pause [--dry-run]</code> | checkpoint every agent worktree to a wip/agent-* ref before the session ends  |
| <code>resume</code>            | the re-spawn plan for a paused session, and writes nothing                    |
| <code>stop [--force]</code>    | clear session state and agent worktrees; every branch and checkpoint survives |

## Publishing

|                                      |                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>caps</code>                    | which features the host has on — makes one network request                        |
| <code>community [--write]</code>     | issue and PR scaffolding for the features that came back on                       |
| <code>publish</code>                 | wiki, pages or a single file, and never without confirmation                      |
| <code>--target wiki</code>           | GitHub Wiki — flattened markdown, links rewritten, drift-guarded                  |
| <code>--target pages</code>          | the full site to a gh-pages branch (dashboard + deck survive)                     |
| <code>--target export</code>         | one self-contained HTML file (--page dashboard index health)                      |
| <code>--ci</code>                    | (GitLab, pages) write the .gitlab-ci.yml job instead — Pages is an artifact there |
| <span>□</span> <code>artifact</code> | the dashboard, health report or index to claude.ai as a shareable page            |

## Agent surfaces

|                                  |                                                                         |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>mcp</code>                 | connect a client to the read-only tool surface                          |
| <code>--status</code>            | what a client would connect to, where it is registered, what is running |
| <code>ask &lt;task&gt;</code>    | answer a question from the corpus                                       |
| <code>prompt [--out FILE]</code> | a system prompt for an agent that cannot load this plugin               |

## Command line only

|                                                    |                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <span>■</span> <code>init</code>                   | write project-atlas.config.json, detecting this repository's layout      |
| <span>■</span> <code>scan [--json]</code>          | build and summarise the index                                            |
| <span>■</span> <code>contention [branch...]</code> | what a fan-out will collide on: files more than one branch touches       |
| <span>■</span> <code>spec --gate</code>            | the commit gate: refuse a staged change whose message names no plan item |
| <span>■</span> <code>serve</code>                  | build, then run the live dashboard detached and open it                  |
| <code>--status   --stop</code>                     | what is running here   end it now                                        |
| <code>--list   --launcher</code>                   | every atlas dashboard on this machine   write a page linking them all    |
| <span>■</span> <code>watch [--serve]</code>        | rebuild on change; --serve hosts it live at http://127.0.0.1:4173        |
| <span>■</span> <code>all</code>                    | scan + health + build                                                    |

|                                    |                                                                            |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Aliases</b>                     | <code>capabilities = caps</code> · <code>git-insight = git-insights</code> |
| <code>--root &lt;dir&gt;</code>    | repository root (default: git toplevel, else cwd)                          |
| <code>--config &lt;path&gt;</code> | config file (default: <root>/project-atlas.config.json)                    |
| <code>--verbose[=all]</code>       | list findings, not just counts                                             |
| <code>--json</code>                | machine-readable output                                                    |

The markdown is the source of truth. Everything this tool writes is derived and safe to delete.

## Flags, on every command

|                        |                                                                           |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>--no-git</code>  | skip git metadata; staleness is reported as unchecked rather than guessed |
| <code>--offline</code> | skip the capability probe; assume features exist and say so               |
| <code>--quiet</code>   | suppress progress output                                                  |
| <code>--force</code>   | (init) overwrite an existing config                                       |